

1 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

First-sound picture hunt

What we are practising

Listen for initial sounds in familiar words.

What you need

Paper / Crayons

Use spoken words without pictures.

Before you begin

Draw sun, sock and moon; say each word naturally.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say “sun” and notice its first /s/ sound.
2. Name the other pictures and choose one starting the same way.
3. Draw another matching object, such as soap, and say its name.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Do sun and moon start with the same sound?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

The lost hat story order

What we are practising

Explain event order using connecting words.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Act out the events instead.

Before you begin

Draw four panels: hat on head; wind blows it; hat in bush; child retrieves it.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Describe the pictures in a mixed order.
2. Ask the child to point to first, next, then and last.
3. Retell the story and explain why retrieving follows losing.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which picture shows why the hat moved?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 10 minutes

Find the rhyming friend

What we are practising

Notice rhyme through spoken examples.

What you need

No materials

Draw objects to support the spoken words.

Before you begin

Say familiar words aloud; reading is unnecessary.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say “cat, hat” and emphasise the shared ending.
2. Ask which rhymes with cat: hat or sun.
3. Try “boat, coat”, then invite another rhyme or playful invented word.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which ending sounds alike?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Letter shapes in a name

What we are practising

Recognise a selected letter in meaningful words.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Book with clear print

An adult writes three short examples.

Before you begin

Write the child's name and choose a letter; show M and m if using "Mona".

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Point to the letter and trace its shape in the air.
2. Write it large, then find it in two familiar words.
3. Compare the examples and circle or point to the letter.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does the letter always look identical?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Interview a family expert

What we are practising

Ask relevant questions and retell an answer.

What you need

Paper / Pencil for optional picture notes

Interview an adult pretending to be a gardener.

Before you begin

Choose a willing adult and topic, such as plant care.

An adult reads or explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Choose two questions: “What do you do?” and “What helps you?”
2. Ask, listen and draw one detail from each answer.
3. Tell another listener something learned and check it with the interviewee.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What new question follows from that answer?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. First-sound picture hunt

A little hint

Listen to the sound, not the letter's alphabet name.

Answer / what to notice

Sun and sock start with /s/; moon starts with /m/. Soap begins with /s/.

Words can share an initial sound while having different meanings.

Make it easier

Offer only two pictures with clearly different starting sounds.

Take it further

Find three words beginning with another sound.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for the chosen sound in familiar object names.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The lost hat story order

A little hint

Look for the wind before the hat lands in the bush.

Answer / what to notice

Hat on head, wind blows it, hat lands in bush, child retrieves it.

Cause-and-effect clues connect the events.

Make it easier

Use three events, leaving out the bush.

Take it further

Add an ending that follows the earlier events.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell a real event from the day in four parts.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Find the rhyming friend

A little hint

Say both words slowly without changing their usual sounds.

Answer / what to notice

Cat rhymes with hat; boat rhymes with coat. Meanings need not match.

Rhyme uses ending sounds; sharing a first letter is not enough.

Make it easier

Repeat a rhyming pair together before choosing.

Take it further

Make a three-word chain; identify any invented words.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for rhyme in a familiar song or poem.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Letter shapes in a name

A little hint

Show uppercase M beside lowercase m.

Answer / what to notice

Find the selected letter; show its uppercase and lowercase forms when needed.

A letter can have more than one visual form.

Make it easier

Match identical handwritten examples only.

Take it further

Find the letter in a new word and name its position.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a name label for a drawing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Interview a family expert

A little hint

Use what, how or why to invite a fuller answer.

Answer / what to notice

Accurately retelling a relevant detail meets the task; kindly clarify misunderstandings.

Follow-up questions build on what the speaker said.

Make it easier

Ask one question and repeat its answer together.

Take it further

Invent a follow-up question without prompting.

Another day, away from the screen

Add a caption to a picture about the interview.